



A Healthy Mind in a Healthy Body

Lifestyle Medicine Small Group

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ER Module

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Objectives

- SOM.PF.I.BPM2.9.NB.4.BEHS.0169: Apply self-assessment tools in the domains of stress, anxiety, depression, physical activity, and sleep to design a holistic individualized treatment plan
- SOM.PF.I.BPM2.9.NB.4.BEHS.0170: Apply behavioral interventions designed to decrease stress and increase self-health promoting behaviors
- SOM.PF.I.BPM2.9.NB.4.BEHS.0171: Illustrate why behavioral changes, such as increasing physical activity, can be difficult, using a case study about a patient who has to make health-related changes, and self-reflect on what challenges they may face.

Lifestyle Medicine

- Lifestyle medicine is an evidence-based approach to preventing, treating and even reversing diseases by replacing unhealthy behaviors with positive ones — such as eating a healthy balanced diet, being physically active, managing stress, avoiding risky substance abuse, adequate sleep and having a strong support system.
- The practice of Lifestyle Medicine starts with you.



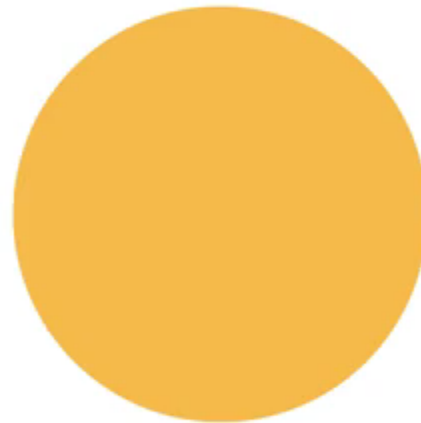
Part I: Assessment

- Please complete the following assessment measures in your small group manual:
 - 1) Depression, Anxiety, Stress Scale
 - 2) Physical Activity Scale
 - 3) Pittsburg Quality Sleep Index
- When you have finished the scales, please score them and refer to the clinical ranges for each scale.

Part II: Square Breathing

- Guided Group Exercise

<https://www.healthline.com/health/box-breathing>

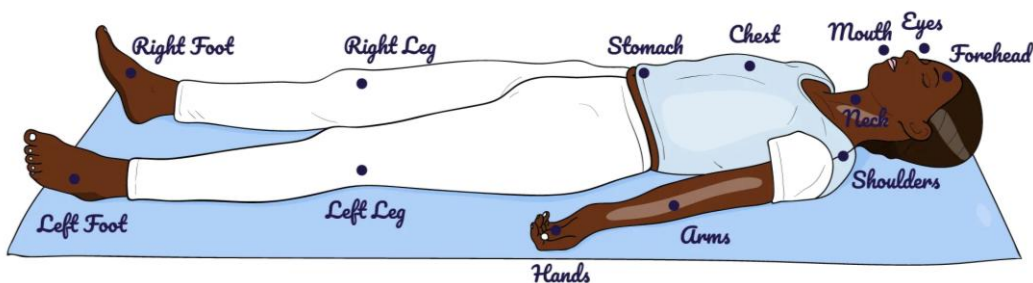


Part III: Mindfulness

- Mindfulness is the practice of purposefully focusing one's attention in the present moment without judgment
- It has roots in Buddhist, Zen, and Tibetan meditation techniques
- Clinical studies have demonstrated the effectiveness of mindfulness for reducing anxiety, depression, stress, worry, rumination, and addiction. It can also reduce inflammation
- Mindfulness can improve physical health and immune function
- How to Practice:
 - Sit quietly and monitor your breath
 - Body-scan meditation for body sensations in the present moment
 - MBSR – focus on sounds, sensations, thoughts, feelings and actions in the moment

Part IV: Progressive Muscle Relaxation

- Guided Group Exercise
- <https://youtu.be/1nZEdqcGVzo>



Part V: Physical Activity Guidelines

- Adults aged 18–64
 - 3 times per week of aerobic physical activity
 - To a total of at least 150 minutes of moderate-intensity (or 75 minutes of vigorous) aerobic physical activity each week
 - and 2 days of resistance (strength) training including all major muscle groups
- Aerobic activity is most effective if done in bouts of at least 10 minutes duration
- For additional health benefits, adults should increase their moderate-intensity aerobic physical activity to 300 minutes per week, or engage in 150 minutes of vigorous-intensity aerobic physical activity per week, or an equivalent combination of moderate- and vigorous-intensity activity
- Studies have shown that older adults should do more strength related exercise

Part VI: Sleep

- Sleep is important for brain function
- 6-8 hours ideally (and less than 9)
- In addition to memory consolidation deep sleep also activates the glymphatic system
- The glymphatic system clears buildup byproducts from energy used during the day
- <https://youtu.be/5MulMqhT8DM?si=E-emmLY5j4P24q94>

Part VII: Sleep Hygiene Recommendations

- Maintain consistent sleep schedule
- Use bed only to sleep (with exception of sex)
 - Lie down only when tired
 - If not asleep in 20 min, depart bed and return only when tired
 - If you wake up early, don't stay in bed
- Avoid caffeine, esp. after noon
- Exercise *more than* 2 hrs before bedtime
- Take hot bath *within* 2 hrs of bedtime

Part VII: Sleep Hygiene Recommendations

- Create an environment conducive to sleep, including:
 - Cool bedroom temperature (via a/c, fans)
 - Bedroom darkness (blackout curtains, eye shades)
 - Bedroom quietness (white noise machines [fans, humidifiers] earplugs)

Part VII: Sleep Hygiene Recommendations

- **Avoid stimuli not conducive to sleep**, including avoidance of (or at least limiting):
 - Bright light from cell phones, computer screens, and TV screens (some recommend turning off devices at least 30 minutes before bedtime)
 - Night-time alcohol (facilitates sleep onset, but disrupts sleep architecture)
 - Night-time fluids (restricting fluid intake can pre-empt night-time awakenings for bathroom breaks)
 - Foods causing indigestion (e.g., some people experience indigestion from rich foods, fatty/fried meals, spicy dishes, citrus fruits), which can cause heartburn and disrupts sleep.
 - Lowfat Greek yogurt is an excellent choice of late night (too hungry to sleep) snack

Part VIII: Behavioral Methods for Sleep Control

Use relaxation
techniques: such as

Square breathing

progressive muscle
relaxation

Part IX: Nutrition

- Pay attention to what you eat
- Focus on nutrient dense foods
- Eat at regular times every day
- Eat enough!!

Part X: Group Activity

- Using the case study included in your manual, please complete the following:
 - Discuss and note at least 2 possible barriers to making these behavioral changes. Barriers may include physical, social, physiological and/or financial.
 - Be prepared to share with the class.

Part XI: Self-Reflection

- Take a moment to think about a health habit you would like to adopt or change
 - Why do you want to make the change?
 - What would your life be like with this change implemented?
- Think about what motivates you to make this change
 - How motivated are you (1= not at all, 10=highly motivated)
- Are you ready to make the change?
 - (1, I have not thought about it before today; 2, I thought about it before; 3, I have thought about it and made a plan; 4, I have started making a change <6months ago; I made the change >6months ago and still going strong)
- Have you attempted to make this change before?
 - What barriers did you face when you tried to make the change?
 - Are the barriers still there? Are there other barriers?
 - What do you need to overcome these barriers?

Closing Thoughts

Which
technique(s) are
you open to trying
this term?

Who can you
identify to be your
support
buddy(ies)?

Who can YOU
support?

Additional Campus Resources

- Academic Advising (AADS)
academicadvisingSOM@sgu.edu
- Psychological Services Center (PSC)
pscscheduling@sgu.edu
- Department of Educational Services (DES)
<https://www.sgu.edu/student-support-services/departments-educational-services/>
- The Well on SGU Portal
- Office of Student Affairs (dos@sgu.edu)
- EthicsPoint Compliance Hotline
<http://www.sgu.ethicspoint.com/> or call 1-844-423-5100.

Featured Community: The Well



Being healthy and staying well can significantly impact your ability to succeed at Saint George's University. The Well Program is a collection of all Health and Wellness activities and resources that Saint George's University has to offer to its Students, Staff and Faculty.

[Visit The Well](#)

University Policies and Procedures

- [Student Manuals](#)
- [Judicial Disciplinary Process](#)
- [SGU Alcohol Tobacco and Other Drug Use Policy](#)
- [SGU Policy for Scooter and Motorbike use in Grenada](#)
- [Leave of Absence/Withdrawal Application](#)
- [Instructions for Leave of Absence Application](#)
- [Instructions for Withdrawal Application](#)
- [Sexual Misconduct Policy](#)
- [Sexual Misconduct Reporting Chart](#)
- [EthicsPoint Reporting Hotline](#)